

The Whistling Peaking

Zea, Leona, Rudy, Albedo

We head northeast for 1.5 days before we reach The Silent Woods. After some character conflict, we head further northeast for half a day before settling for the night.

During watch, Albedo sees a cloaked figure approach and wakes up the party. When it approaches, it seems to be Henka but evil. Albedo attacks him, and when he is almost defeated he turns into slime. A moment later, acid walls emerge around every party member and enemies spawn. We defeat them.

We rest and continue northeast into The Silent Woods. We stumble upon a ruin where Zea has been ambushed before. Albedo sneaks into the camp and sees dormant oozes. Zea and Rudy start shooting fire at the camp while we leave for the flying island. We continue walking northeast, and see a treeline in the distance. In the north we see a slime wall where the Red Wall should be. We hypothesize that the slime needs something to copy. We short rest.

In the second shift, Rudy gets woken up by the telepathic voice of whatever possesses Henka, and he says he is called the Informant. (A very powerful demon who was also present in the Howling woods when the gnolls were performing their death ritual that Rudy, Oreo, Laowai and Henka encountered. Knowing this, Rudy makes a deal with him for safe passage. He destroys Rudy's spellbook. To haunt Rudy of what happened, he shows us the worst moments of that mission) (Rudy makes a deal with something. He loses his spellbooks and the other party gets shown memories of Rudy's naughty behaviour on an acid wall. He does this for more information.)

The acid walls display Rudy, Oreo, Henka and Laowai. They walk into the Howling Woods, and see a rune meaning "carnage" everywhere. They are pulsing with dark energy, but they ignore it to wait nearby the Gnoll fortress, they wait while Wycian is not doing much. There is a lot of magic coming out of the fortress, and only after more than 1 hour, they try to take action. They destroy a tower and kill one of their leaders but get lost afterward. Then, they see the destructive ritual start and wait, only Henka flees but gets killed by Gnolls. The Howling Woods are destroyed with everything and everyone in it. (Then, we see a battle for Sheng Fu Keep, where Laowai and Rudy obtain a piece of a magical crown. They never report it and store it. We know where it is. Rudy is the crown's bearer and protector. It is in his possession. He is researching and gathering information to gather the other pieces to restore the world. It is his mission and he can be trusted to do so.)

The memories end, and Leona and Albedo are pissed. Rudy tries to dissuade us from putting this in the report. It won't work.

We discuss this lengthily.

We go to sleep.

We wake up and see and go east towards the treeline. The forest is very lush, the area of decay stops very abruptly. We assume that this is one of the four wonders, the Magical Forest. We head northeast towards the floating island. We happen upon a very well

camouflaged house among the trees. Nyx looks through an opening and sees 2 unmoving trees in human form embracing each other in what seems like a dance. In the backs of the trees, there are empty hand prints. Albedo puts his hand in and feels suffused with nature energy. With Shamir, it does not activate. Rudy investigates and says it is malevolent fey energy. He removes his hand. Upon further investigation, we find a trapdoor and find that everything is made of wood. We enter the trapdoor and see a wine cellar made of wood with 2 magical red roses growing out of a workbench. We pluck the flowers and give them to the dancing trees, while we stand outside for safety. The petals from the flowers coalesce and form into three large, red mothlike creature. They ask for professions of love, we give them to each other. They show us a vision of what happened to the cottage. It shows 2 girls being happy around this specific house, they grow into teenagers and profess their love with a rose, and even later they have a beautiful wedding where they dance. Over time everything turns into wood, they do while dancing together. The moths disappear. We leave a note warning other Striders.

When walking further towards the mountains, we discover an entire city being turned into wood. We will explore the city further in another expedition. We call it Rosewood City, and the Rosewood Forest.

Upon setting up camp, we notice a lot of poisonous food. During the first watch, Albedo notices a creature of woods emerging out of a tree surrounded by butterflies. It teleports through the trees towards us and attacks with a butterfly swarm. We defeat them. We finish our rest.

We travel another half day northeast and we reach the foot of the mountain.